



KNOW HOW?

QA & SECTION

Q I have been using OpenSUSE 11.3 (GNOME version) for a while now. Recently, I purchased a new laptop and shifted all my data from my old laptop to the new one. I installed OpenSUSE 11.3 (GNOME version) on the new laptop also. While I can see all my old data on the new laptop, my data stored in Tomboy application notes is missing. One of my friends suggested that Tomboy's data resides in '~/.tomboy as .note' files. I have searched a lot but could not find the '.tomboy' folder on my system. There is a lot of data that I stored as notes in the Tomboy application and I need to recover it, urgently. Kindly help me.

—Prasenjit Chatterji, Kolkata

Tomboy's data resides in a folder named '~/.local/share/tomboy'. Copy this data to your new laptop and restart Tomboy. You will find all your notes there.

Q I use Ubuntu on my laptop and have Wi-Fi broadband Internet access. I want to share this service with a few other computers that are connected to mine, locally, through the wired connection. Is this possible? If so, then please let me know how to achieve this.

—Vineet Kumar, Noida, UP

What I understand from your question is that you need to share

your Internet connection with other desktop/laptop users by creating a LAN. The simplest way to achieve this is to convert your laptop into a gateway to share the Internet connection by using 'iptables'.

You will need two network cards on your laptop—one to connect to the Internet and the other to the LAN. Now connect to your broadband connection using the Wi-Fi route (eth0, external or WAN) and share it with others via the wire connected to the Ethernet port 'eth1' (internal or LAN). Given below are the configurations that are required on the gateway (i.e. your Ubuntu Laptop) and the client computer.

Here are the steps you need to follow to configure the gateway.

Configure the internal network card (eth1) for the IP address, assuming that eth0 has already been configured to access the Wi-Fi broadband connection and the Internet is activated on your system.

```
sudo ifconfig eth1 192.168.100.1
```

Now, configure 'iptables' for NAT

```
sudo iptables -A FORWARD -o eth0 -i eth1 -s
192.168.100.0/24 -m conntrack --ctstate NEW
-j ACCEPT
```

```
sudo iptables -A FORWARD -m conntrack
--ctstate ESTABLISHED,RELATED -j ACCEPT
```

```
sudo iptables -A POSTROUTING -t nat -j
MASQUERADE
```

The steps you need to follow to configure the client computer are as follows.

The client should be connected to your Ubuntu box through a switch or cross cable. Assign a static IP to the client in the same subnet as the gateway:

```
sudo ifconfig eth0 192.168.100.10
```

Now, add the default gateway:

```
sudo route add default gw 192.168.100.1
```

Next, make the necessary changes in '/etc/resolv.conf' to add the nameserver.

Finally, open your browser and start using the Internet on the client machine.

Q I have installed CentOS 5.3 on my laptop along with Windows XP. After the installation, my computer boots into CentOS by default. If I need to go to Windows, I have to select it manually. I would like to know how to make Windows the default OS.

—Parul Sangwan, New Delhi

You can make the changes in the Grub configuration file by using the command mentioned below.

Open the file '/etc/grub.conf' in any text editor by typing the following code:

```
# vi /etc/grub.conf
```

...and change the default value from...

```
default=0
```

...to:

```
default=1
```

Here, '1' represents the second OS on the machine, which is Windows XP in this case.

Now, type in:

```
:wq
```

This will save and quit the vi editor.

Now, when you reboot your system, it will boot into Windows XP by default.  **END**